

BUYERS' GUIDE

ESTYLE

POCKET-FRIENDLY MICROWAVES



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Microwaves have always established a special place in every kitchen. You cannot ignore the importance of a microwave. If you want to save time, save on gas or have a quick bite, a microwave is essentially an answer to all of these. In today's busy schedule, we are always looking for faster and easier ways of cooking. It does not make a difference if you are living a bachelor's life, are married or are elderly, you simply cannot ignore the significance of a microwave.

Factors like family size and food habits should also be kept in mind while buying a microwave. New-age microwave ovens are much faster and easier to use. Everyone can become a chef with a microwave costing less than ₹ 10,000.

Even though customers can find most of the required features under ₹ 10,000, these tend to lose out on some exclusive features that higher-end mod-

els provide. According to a sales manager at LG Electronics, "Our higher-end models provide features like fan at the back, charcoal heating, multi-cook *tawa*, longer warranty period and cooking classes by experts. Customers tend to lose out on these features when they go for sub-10,000 microwaves."

It is surprising that majority of people still use a microwave as a reheating equipment and shun traditional kitchen practices. Every microwave can be used for cooking, frying, baking and grilling. One can cook mouth-watering dishes like *murg tandoori*, *bharwan bhindi*, *naan*, *parathas* and even *kulchas*. You can fry *pakoraa*s, *vadas*, fish and chips using just a little oil. For health-conscious individuals, there is the option of making salads, sprouted lentils and much more.

Parameters to look out for

Some key points you could look out for are:

TOP 5 MICROWAVE OVEN MODELS UNDER ₹ 10,000

	LG MC2149BPB	IFB 25SC3	Haier HIL2590EGC	Godrej GMX 25CA2 FIZ	Whirlpool Magicook 20G 1-Z-3 Microwave
					
Price	₹ 9999	₹ 9990	₹ 9490	₹ 8599	₹ 8499
Features worth looking at	An impressive floral pattern, 76 Auto Cook Menu includes 48 Indian dishes at the touch of a button. It has a stainless-steel cavity, promising uniformity of heating for better cooking, fan at the back and multi-cook <i>Tawa</i> .	With a capacity of 25 litres, this microwave comes with a pre-heat facility, steam-clean feature, automatic multi-stage cooking, express cooking function to decrease cooking time and deodoriser to remove odours.	This is a 25-litre unit specially designed to clean anti-bacterial stainless-steel cavity. Combining cooking options like Grill + Convection, Micro + Grill and Micro + Convection are available. It is enabled with Quartz grill for uniform grilling of food, which is user-friendly. There are five different power levels, auto-defrost plus Indian auto-cook menu.	The 25-litre unit by Godrej has 40 instant-cook Indian menus. Other features include multi-stage cooking, express cooking, auto reminder, child lock, deodorizer, stainless-steel cavity, ceramic enamel cavity and 36 auto menus. It also comes with a recipe book by Tarla Dalal.	This microwave griller is designed with precision and comes at reasonable price with a long-term warranty. It has a unique taste-binding technology that will keep the taste and freshness of the food at its best. Its sleek design makes it a favourite of every kitchen.

The prices mentioned here are from various e-commerce portals and are subject to change.